

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Cloud Security | Azure and Microsoft 365 | Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) / Extended Detection and Response (XDR) | Automation

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience designing, implementing, and managing security measures to protect cloud and hybrid infrastructure environments. I have a strong track record in Microsoft Azure and Microsoft 365 security, Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) / Extended Detection and Response (XDR) platform management, vulnerability management, and security automation. I bring deep hands-on knowledge of Microsoft Entra Identity (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Sentinel, and PowerShell scripting, and I am experienced in working across public cloud, Software as a Service (SaaS), and on-premises environments. I understand how to translate security frameworks such as the National Institute of Standards and Technology Cybersecurity Framework (NIST CSF), CIS Controls, and ISO 27001 into practical engineering controls, and I thrive in environments where security outcomes are measured, repeatable, and continually improved. I am equally comfortable working with clients to understand their security requirements and communicating risk and technical recommendations clearly to both technical and non-technical stakeholders.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure security services and best practices; Microsoft 365 (M365) security - Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Purview; Microsoft Entra Identity (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access Policies
- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) / Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** Microsoft Sentinel (Kusto Query Language (KQL) - detection engineering, analytics, alert tuning); CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and XDR platform
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover - Expert); Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) and Scripting:** Microsoft Sentinel playbooks, Logic Apps; PowerShell scripting and automation; Azure Command-Line Interface (CLI)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; risk prioritisation and remediation tracking
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM) / Privileged Access Management (PAM):** Microsoft Entra Identity, Conditional Access, MFA/SSO, BeyondTrust PAM, role-based access control (RBAC)
- **Email and Web Security:** Mimecast email security gateway; proxy and web filtering management
- **Mobile Device Management (MDM) / Mobile Application Management (MAM):** Microsoft Intune; endpoint compliance policy management
- **Security Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, Tier 2/3 SOC investigation and containment

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Design, implement, review, and manage security measures to protect the organisation's Azure and Microsoft 365 environments across an 8,000-user estate, applying deep knowledge of Azure and M365 security services and best practices.
- Manage and optimise CrowdStrike Falcon Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) / Extended Detection and Response (XDR) and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) platforms, authoring detection rules and tuning policies to improve threat visibility and reduce alert fatigue.

- Author Kusto Query Language (KQL) detections and analytics in Microsoft Sentinel to identify threats across identity, endpoint, cloud, and email data sources.
- Design and maintain Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel using Logic Apps and PowerShell to automate alert triage, containment, and notification workflows.
- Administer Microsoft Entra Identity (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access Policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and Single Sign-On (SSO) to enforce Zero Trust access principles.
- Manage BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to enforce least-privilege and just-in-time access for privileged accounts and service identities.
- Configure and maintain Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies and security baselines.
- Lead vulnerability management using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Nessus; prioritise risk and track remediation to closure.
- Administer Mimecast email security gateway, managing anti-phishing policies, impersonation protection, and threat intelligence feeds.
- Develop PowerShell and Azure CLI automation scripts to streamline security engineering tasks and improve operational efficiency.
- Perform Tier 2/3 incident response investigations including containment, eradication, recovery, and lessons-learned reporting in line with NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK.
- Contribute to ISO 27001-aligned information security management, risk assessments, and Cyber Essentials+ certification activities.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Performed SIEM alert triage and investigation, correlating events across endpoint, identity, network, and cloud data sources to identify and contain threats.
- Supported the implementation and tuning of security monitoring rules and analytics, improving detection coverage and reducing false-positive rates.
- Managed identity and access governance including user provisioning, access reviews, and role-based access control (RBAC) across Active Directory and cloud identity platforms.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using enterprise vulnerability management tooling and tracked remediation activity with relevant teams.
- Supported SOAR playbook design and automation initiatives to reduce manual effort in common security response workflows.
- Delivered phishing simulation and security awareness training campaigns across the organisation.
- Contributed to Cyber Essentials+ certification documentation and ISO 27001-aligned policy and control reviews.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Delivered security engineering and infrastructure support across a SaaS and FinTech platform environment, implementing endpoint, identity, and network security controls.
- Configured MFA, SSO integrations, and Group Policy to enforce least-privilege access and reduce identity-related risk.
- Managed MDM/MAM policies for corporate devices, ensuring endpoint security compliance across the device fleet.
- Performed vulnerability scans, coordinated remediation, and supported ISO 27001-aligned information security management processes.
- Contributed to security quality assurance activities, ensuring security controls were embedded in development and deployment processes.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and implemented security measures protecting an 8,000-user Azure and Microsoft 365 environment, deploying Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across the full estate.

- Built a detection engineering capability in Microsoft Sentinel through the development of Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics and automated SOAR playbooks, measurably reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Led deployment of CrowdStrike Falcon SIEM/XDR and EDR across the enterprise, establishing comprehensive endpoint visibility and advanced threat detection.
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to enforce just-in-time access and reduce standing privilege, significantly reducing the attack surface for privileged account compromise.
- Delivered continuous vulnerability risk reduction through Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) and Tenable.io vulnerability management, enabling risk-based prioritisation and measurable remediation progress.
- Achieved Cyber Essentials Plus certification across the organisation's technical estate, validating the strength of cloud, endpoint, and identity controls.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)